Land at South Marston, Swindon
Additional Archaeology Information
November 2016

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Report
Additional Archaeology Information

Site
Land at South Marston, Swindon

Date
November 2016

Planning Authority
Swindon Borough Council

Prepared and Approved By
Rob Bourn (BA MA MCIfA)

Report Status
Final

Orion Ref
QU-0061

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1.1 Following submission of the Regulation 22 Environmental Statement Further Information, the opportunity arose to complete a further phase of archaeological evaluation trenching in the land to the south east of Rowborough Farm and in the south-eastern portion of the site where a crop of willow trees that had previously prevented trenching had been removed. This additional trenching work was undertaken by Cotswold Archaeology in accordance with the WSI that had previously been agreed with Wiltshire Council and was supported by a revised trench plan that was also agreed with Wiltshire Council. The full report on the trenching was not available at the time of writing. However, the outline mitigation strategy proposed in Chapter10 of the Environmental Statement Further Information, has been updated to take into account the results of the additional trenching works and the discussions that were held with Wiltshire Council during monitoring meeting on site during the fieldwork.

1.2 The last phase of evaluation trenching has resulted in virtually all areas of the proposed development to have been trenched. There are two small areas at the eastern end of the site that have not been able to be trenched and parts of the field to the south east of Rowborough Farm were no able to be trenched due to the cropping regimes in the area. However, the trench locations in this field were agreed with Wiltshire Council. The results of trenching in this area have established that the result of the geophysical survey are correct. That is, there are the remains of a prehistoric field system and a small area of prehistoric settlement. These are considered to be of local significance. The results of the trenching of the south-eastern field within the development area indicate that there is a small area of possible prehistoric activity to the remains of a 19th century building. A single cremation was recorded in the field. The southern part of this area was established to have been badly disturbed by former ponds and their subsequent infill material.

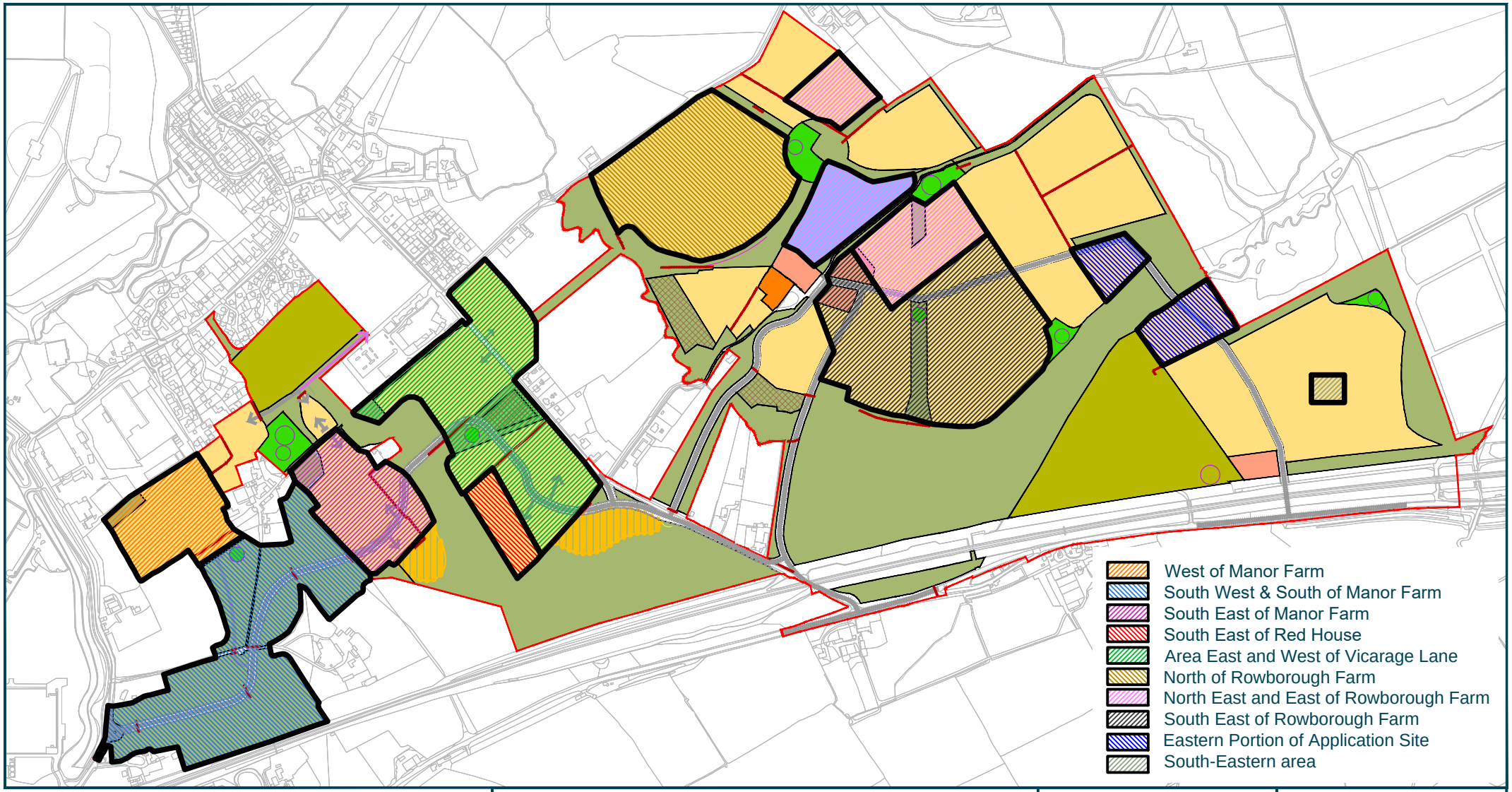
1.3 The following text outlines the proposed mitigation strategy. The areas referred to are shown on Figure 1.

Table 1 Proposed Archaeological Mitigation

Area of Site	Archaeology Present	Proposed Development	Proposed Mitigation
South West & South of Manor Farm	Iron Age and Roman Settlement	Main development access/spine road Informal open space	Excavation & recording Management Plan to ensure long term preservation of below ground archaeological remains
South East of Manor Farm	Iron Age and Roman Settlement	Housing	Excavation & recording
West of Manor Farm	Iron Age and Roman Settlement	Housing	Excavation & recording
South East/East of Red House	Medieval Field System	Housing	Excavation & recording
North of Rowborough Farm	Neolithic/Bronze Age rectangular and circular enclosures	Housing	Excavation & recording

	Roman field boundaries/trackway		Evaluation trenching followed by excavation & recording in the event that the trenching has positive results.
North East, East and South of Rowborough Farm	Bronze Age enclosure and burnt mound	Housing	Excavation & recording
South East of Rowborough Farm	Prehistoric field system & small area of possible prehistoric	Housing	Further trenching of unevaluated parts of the field & excavation & recording of areas of known archaeology
Eastern Portion of Application Site	Probable Prehistoric settlement	Housing	Excavation and recording
Area East and West of Vicarage Lane	None	Housing	None

1.4 The detailed scope and extent of the excavation and recording programme for each area will be agreed with Wilshire Council. A Written Scheme of Investigation outlining the works required for each area, along with research questions to be addressed, excavation ad recording methodology and reporting and final publication will be submitted to Swindon Borough Council and Wiltshire Council. This will be a site wide overarching strategy, although it is anticipated that the works will be implemented ahead of each phase of the developments commencing. Each individual phase of works will require its own specific Written Scheme of Investigation submitted and agreed with Swindon Borough Council and Wiltshire Council.



Legend:

Scale at A4: 1:10,000

0 200m

Title:
Fig. 1: Mitigation Areas in Table 10.1

Address:
Land at South Marston and Rowborough, Swindon New East Villages.

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